Stefan Herytash

sherytash.github.io

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**Thyra Uth Thomsen, Head of Department, and the assessment committee**
Department of Marketing
Copenhagen Business School
Solbjerg Plads 3
2000 Frederiksberg, Denmark

# Application for the Tenure Track Assistant Professorship in Digital Marketing

Dear Thyra Uth Thomsen and members of the assessment committee,

I apply for the Tenure Track Assistant Professorship in Digital Marketing. I am an Assistant Professor at WU Vienna and a mathematician by training, from TU Wien and the University of Zurich. I took my PhD in Management, summa cum laude, at the Institute for Market-Based Management of LMU Munich, with a thesis on simulating human decision-making with large language models. From January to March 2027 I am a Visiting Scholar at Stanford University with the Scandinavian Consortium for Organizational Research, of which CBS is a founding member. I have taught thirteen courses at three business schools.

My solo-authored paper "When and How to Integrate AI Simulations into Behavioral Experimentation" (Revise & Resubmit at the *International Journal of Research in Marketing*) measures how far answers written by a language model can replace consumers in marketing experiments: across 70 treatment effects from 30 published studies, simulated and human effects correlate at $r = .73$, but the simulated effects come out at about two-fifths of the human magnitudes. "Synthetic Participants Reproduce Effects They Cannot Replace" shows that however many synthetic respondents a study adds, it still needs the share $1 - \rho^2$ of its human respondents, $\rho$ being the correlation between a human's response and the simulator's response for that human. "After the Fax Machine Burns", also solo-authored and submitted to *Management Science* as a Discussion Paper, develops a publication system in which every submission is published on arrival and graded afterward. I am one of 156 analyst teams in the many-analyst study of brand price elasticities forthcoming in the *International Journal of Research in Marketing*, and one of 79 authors of "Post-training Makes Large Language Models Less Human-like" (under review), which introduces the Psych-201 dataset.

A second stream asks what platform thresholds certify: the salary band kununu displays once enough employees have reported one, for which a multi-year data partnership is in negotiation, Airbnb's Superhost badge, and pay transparency, with Revelio Labs data.

At WU I designed *Agentic AI in Strategy & Innovation*, in which students build and evaluate working agents; 95 % of the students recommend it. At LMU students rated me 10 out of 10 on average as instructor in *Project Management* and 9 out of 10 in *Marketing Management*. I raised over €100,000 in research funding from industry partners for my LMU institute, received the Excellence Mentoring Stipend of LMU's School of Management and the LMU Management Alumni award for my doctorate, and was selected for the Doctoral Summer School on AI of the League of European Research Universities at the University of Copenhagen.

My benchmark so far compares simulations with published results; CogLab and the experiments.cbs.dk participant pool would let me run the simulated and the human version of the same study side by side on Danish samples. Felix Eggers' work on language-model valuations and design priors for choice experiments is the closest to mine I know. The Digital Marketing Research Cluster works on online promotions and the platform economy, the two settings of my data work. Denmark adds data I cannot get in Austria: Statistics Denmark's linked employer-employee registers, on which I would test whether pay transparency changes whom firms hire, and Salling Group, Carlsberg and Trustpilot as partners I would approach.

I will relocate to Copenhagen. I am eager to learn Danish. I would offer a master's elective on generative AI as a marketing research method, next to *Brand Analytics*, teach general marketing at bachelor's level, as at LMU and EM Lyon, and in executive programmes, as in WU's *Vienna Innovation Program*, and explain what my research means for society in talks for practitioners.

I can start on 1 September 2027. The application documents are also at `https://sherytash.github.io/for/cbs/`.

Sincerely,

Stefan Herytash